

Solstice Insurance — Claims Processing SOP

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This document describes how claims support agents should process, evaluate, and communicate outcomes for incoming claims. It applies to all agents handling first-notification-of-loss intake through final claim disposition, across all Solstice product lines.

When a claim is first received, the agent must verify the policy is active as of the date of loss, confirm the claimant's identity against the policy record, and log the claim in the claims system within 4 business hours of receipt. Claims involving amounts above the agent's individual approval authority must be escalated to a Senior Claims Adjuster before any determination is communicated to the customer.

A claim may be denied for several distinct reasons, each governed by a different policy clause and requiring different customer communication. Late filing denials apply when a claim is submitted more than 90 days after the date of loss, unless the customer can demonstrate good cause for the delay. Pre-existing condition exclusion denials apply when the loss relates to a condition explicitly excluded under the customer's specific coverage tier. Policy lapse denials apply when the policy was not active on the date of loss due to non-payment, and are handled differently from late-filing denials because they may be eligible for retroactive reinstatement under certain conditions.

Agents must never communicate a denial determination verbally without also providing the specific clause reference and appeal process in writing within 2 business days. Compliance has flagged that verbal-only denial communication, even when technically correct, has previously led to complaints that could not be resolved without a clear written record.

Every determination — approval or denial — must be logged with the specific reason code from the standard reason-code list, not free text, so that Compliance can run aggregate reviews. Free-text customer notes may be added for context but must never replace the standard reason code as the basis for a determination.

Appeals of a denial must be reviewed by an adjuster who was not involved in the original determination, within 10 business days of the appeal being logged. If the appeal is upheld, the original denial is reversed and the claim reprocessed for payment within a further 5 business days.

This SOP is reviewed and reissued whenever a material change occurs to denial criteria, escalation authority, or communication requirements. Agents should always confirm the Version and Effective Date shown above before relying on this document for a live customer interaction.